

Tree scale: 0.1

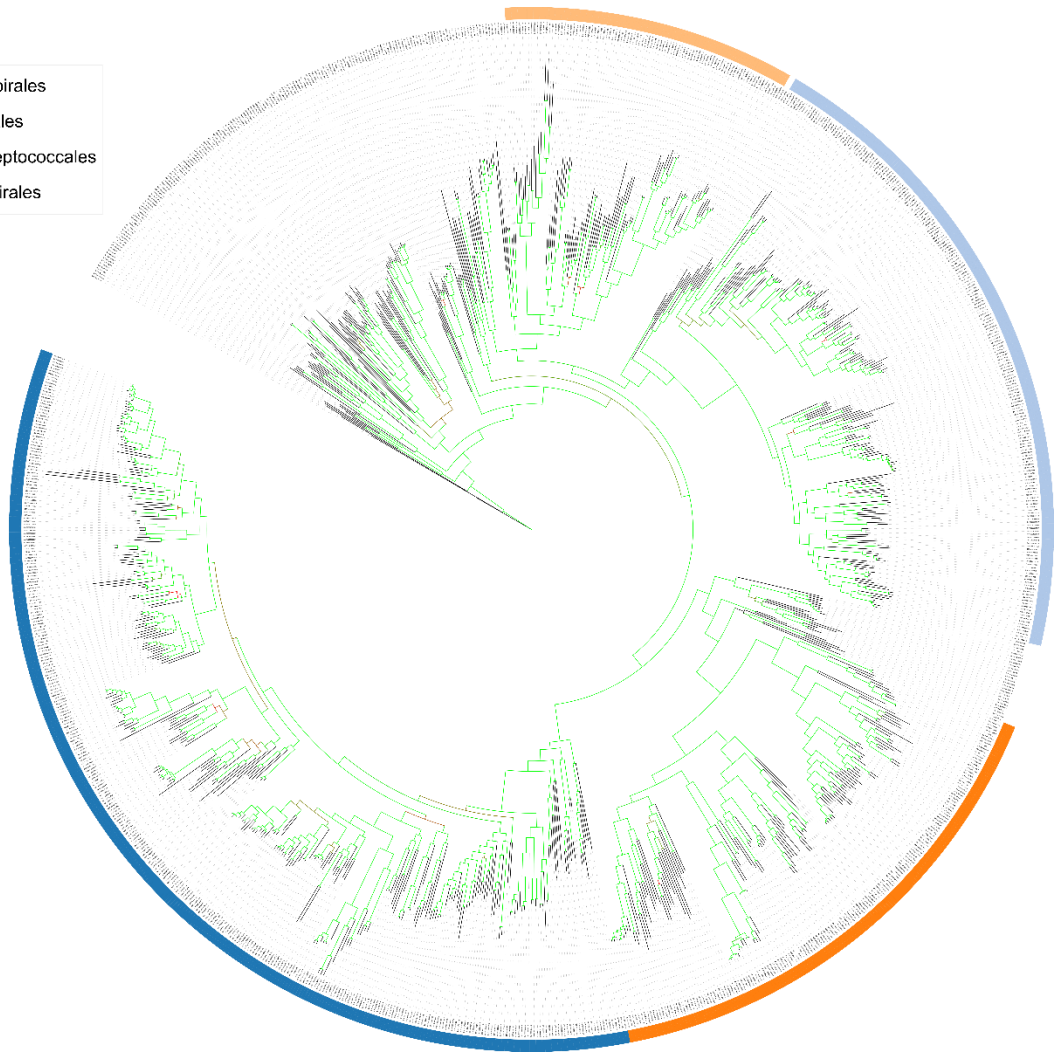


Figure S1. Rooted phylogeny annotated by taxonomic order according to GTDB (colour ring). Together, the four selected clostridial orders cover a large part of the *Clostridia* class.

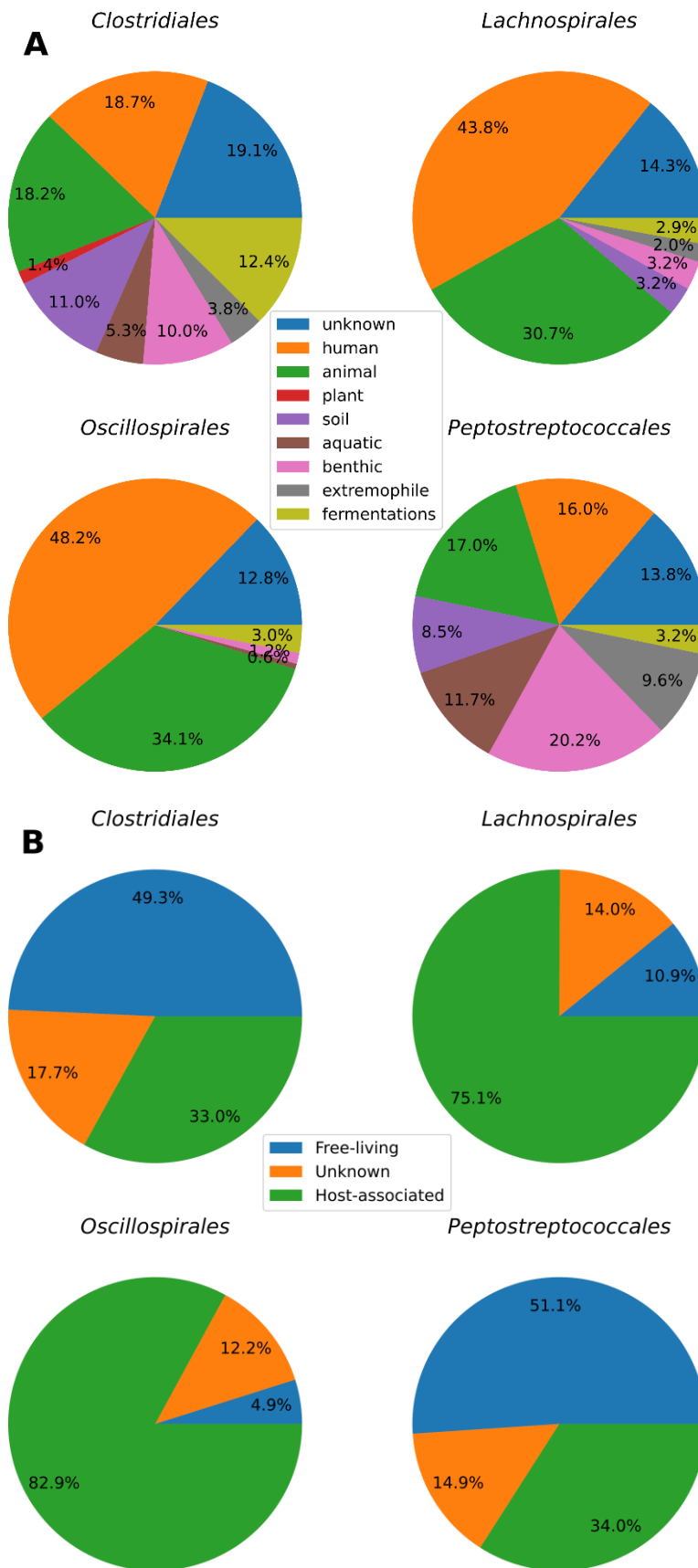


Figure S2. Metadata-inferred (A) habitat and (B) lifestyle classifications of the analysed genomes. *Clostridiales* and *Peptostreptococcales* show both a mix in free-living and host-associated species isolated in various environments. *Lachnospirales* and *Oscillospirales* are predominantly host-associated species isolated from animals and humans.

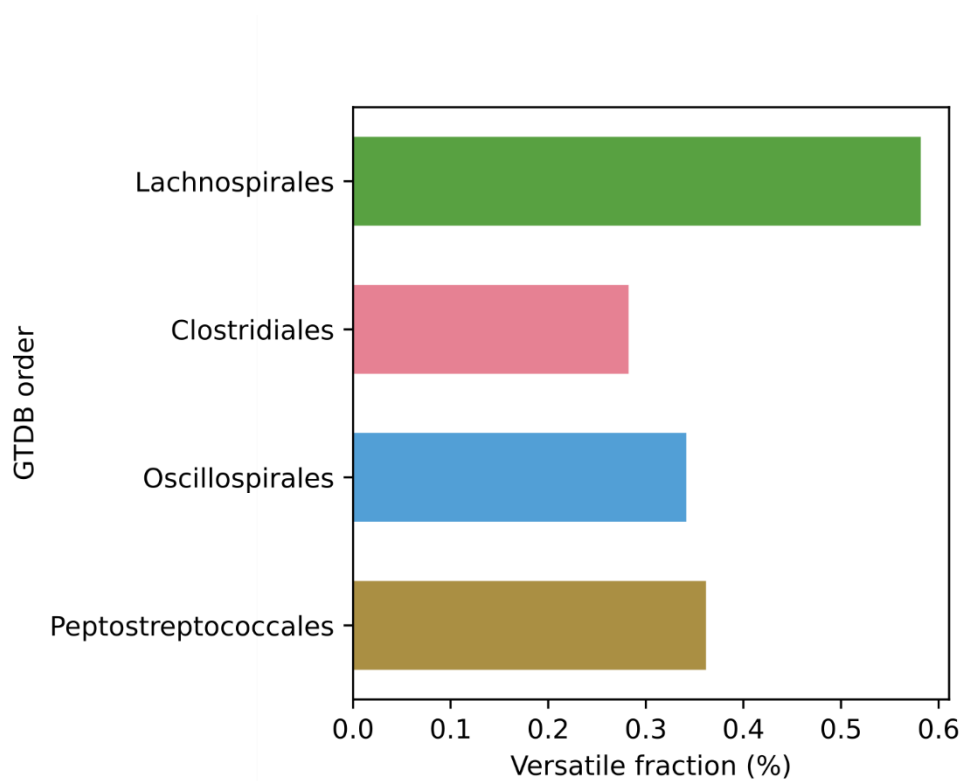


Figure S3. Fraction of the species in each order that is metabolically versatile according to the hierarchical clustering of the KEGG completeness analysis. The *Lachnospirales* have a remarkable high fraction compared to the other orders, indicating a higher tendency for metabolic versatility than anticipated for an order dominated by host-associated species.

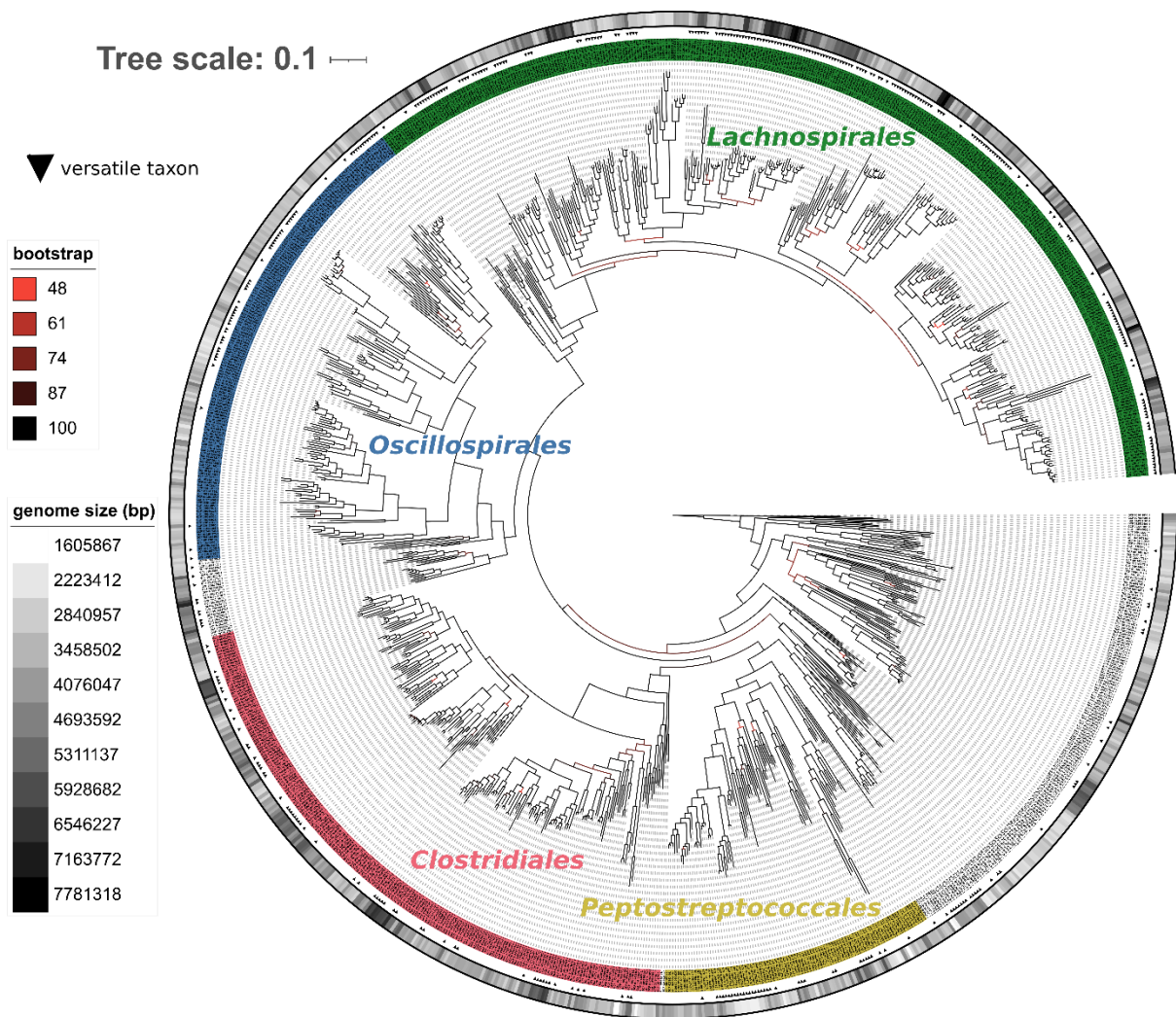


Figure S4. Rooted phylogeny annotated by taxonomic order (label colour), bootstrap support (branch colour), genome size (colour gradient ring) and high metabolic versatility (black triangular markers). Metabolically versatility does not cluster well with phylogenetic descent nor with genome size (except for *Clostridiales*), yet some lineages are consistently versatile.

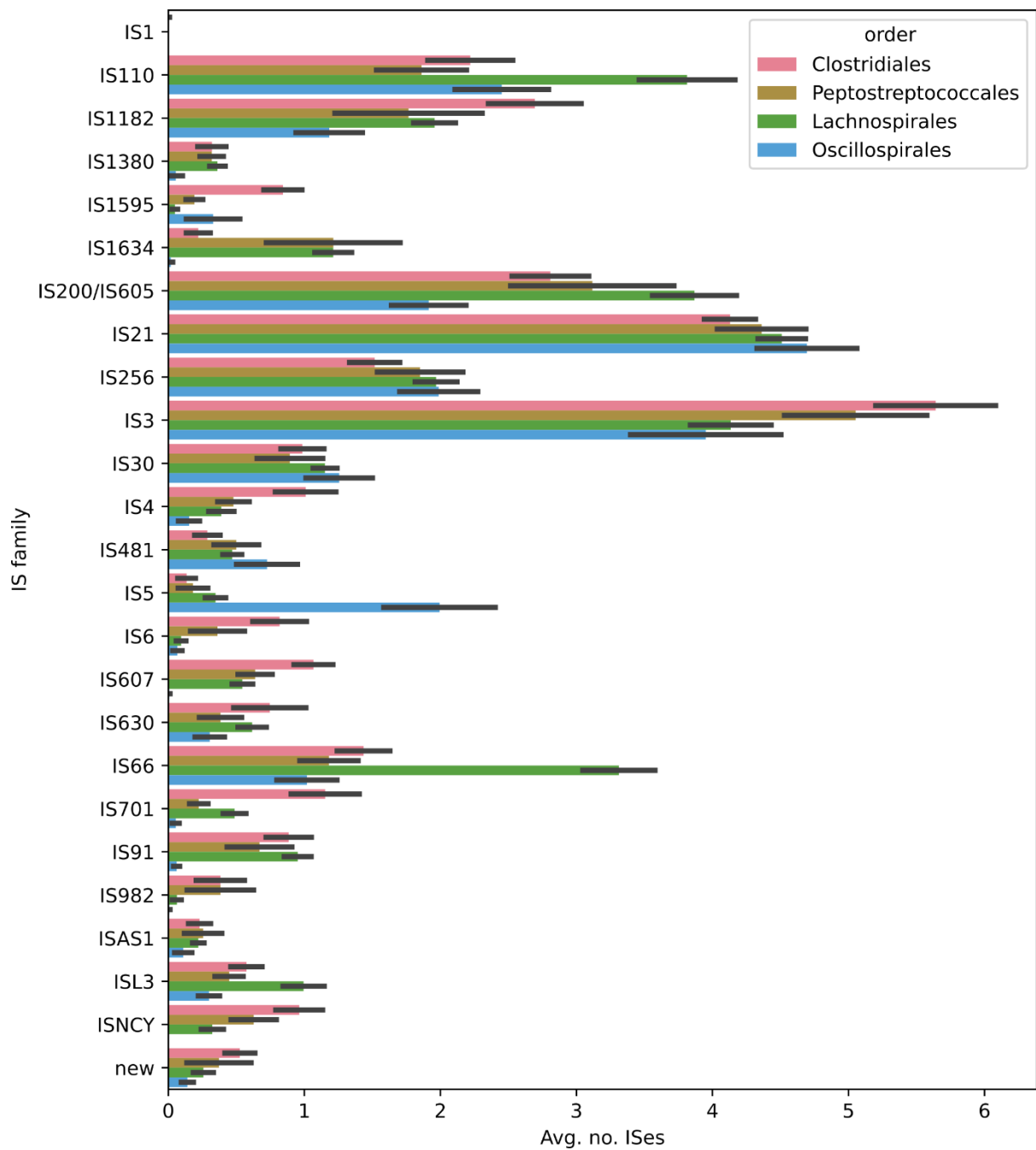


Figure S6. Average number of IS family members present in each taxonomic order, including standard error of the mean.

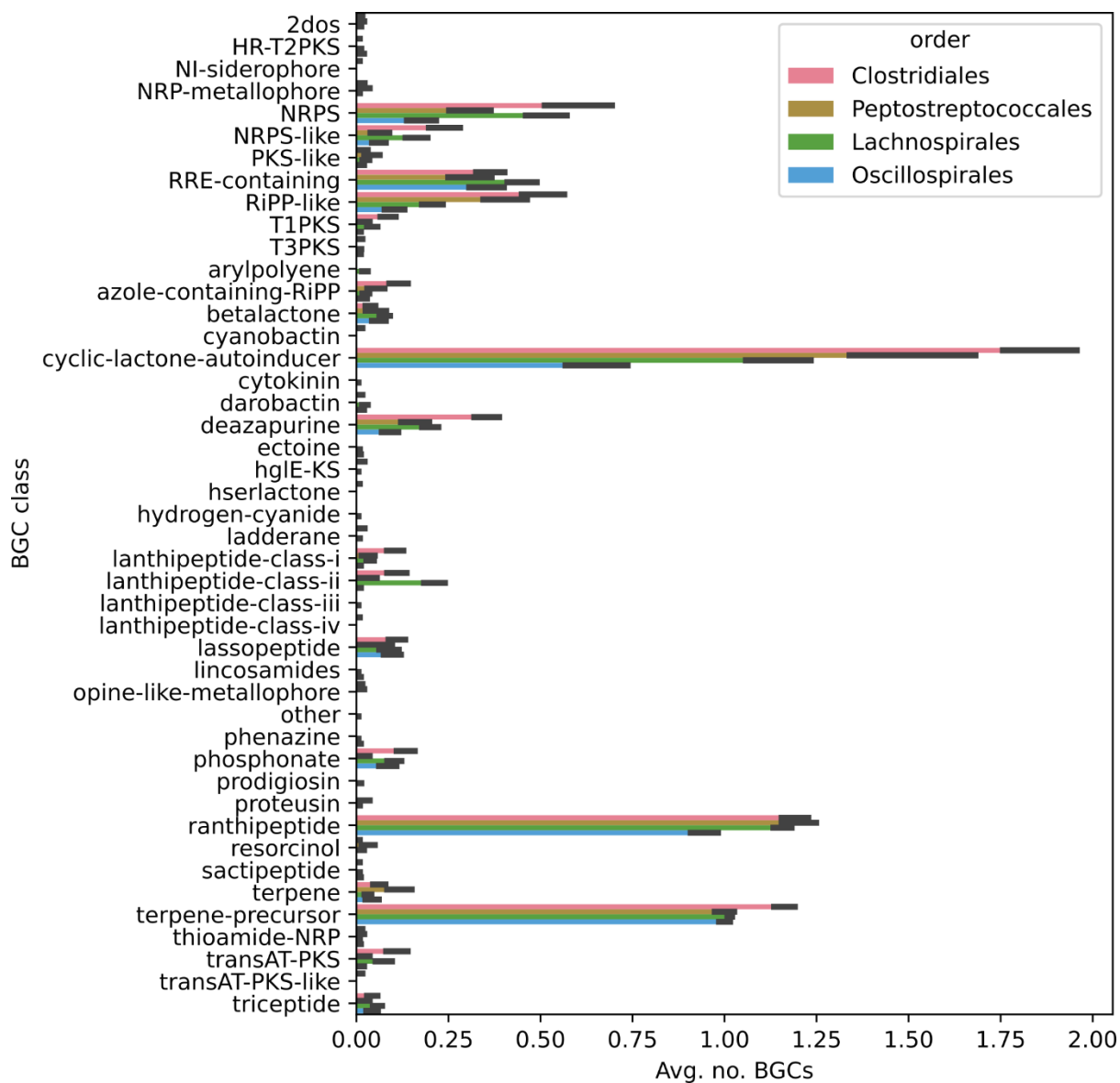


Figure S7. Average number of BGC types present in each taxonomic order, including standard error of the mean.

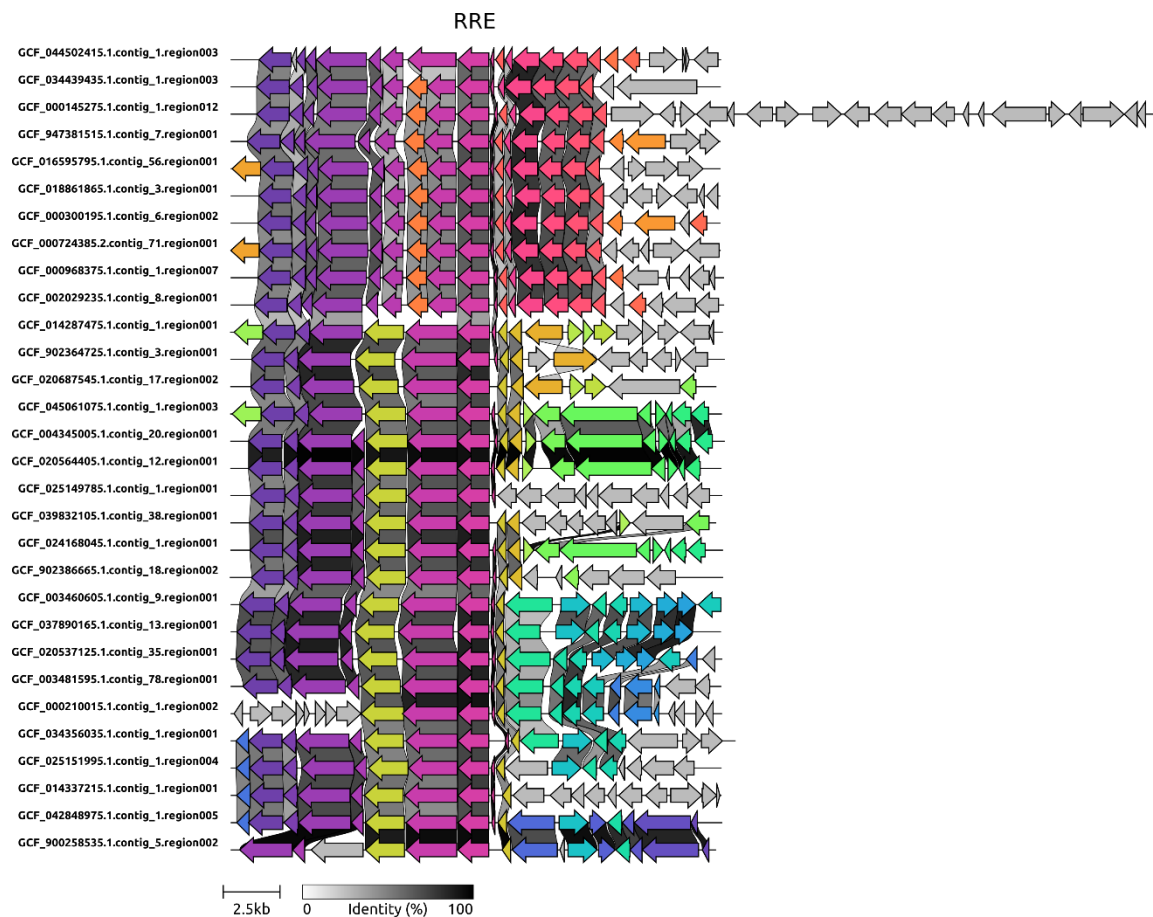


Figure S8. BGC gene alignment of a selection of ranthipeptide BGCs from the three biggest ranthipeptide BGC groups. The RRE gene (and the SCIFF precursor to the right, if detected) are well conserved across all three groups.

Tree scale: 1

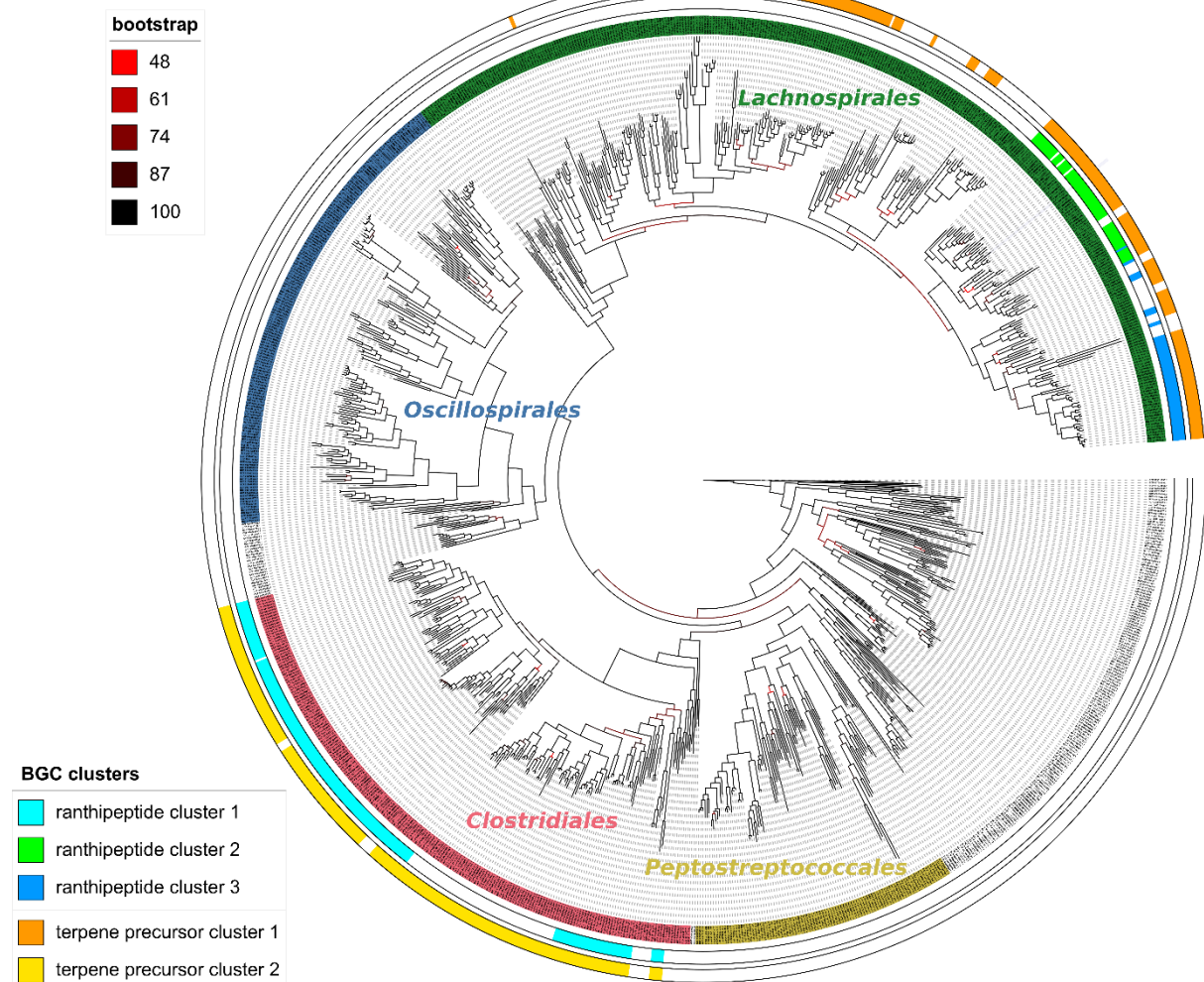


Figure S9. Rooted core genome phylogeny of the full clostridial genome set annotated by taxonomic order and by BGC group for the five biggest BGC group (three ranthipeptide and two terpene precursor groups).

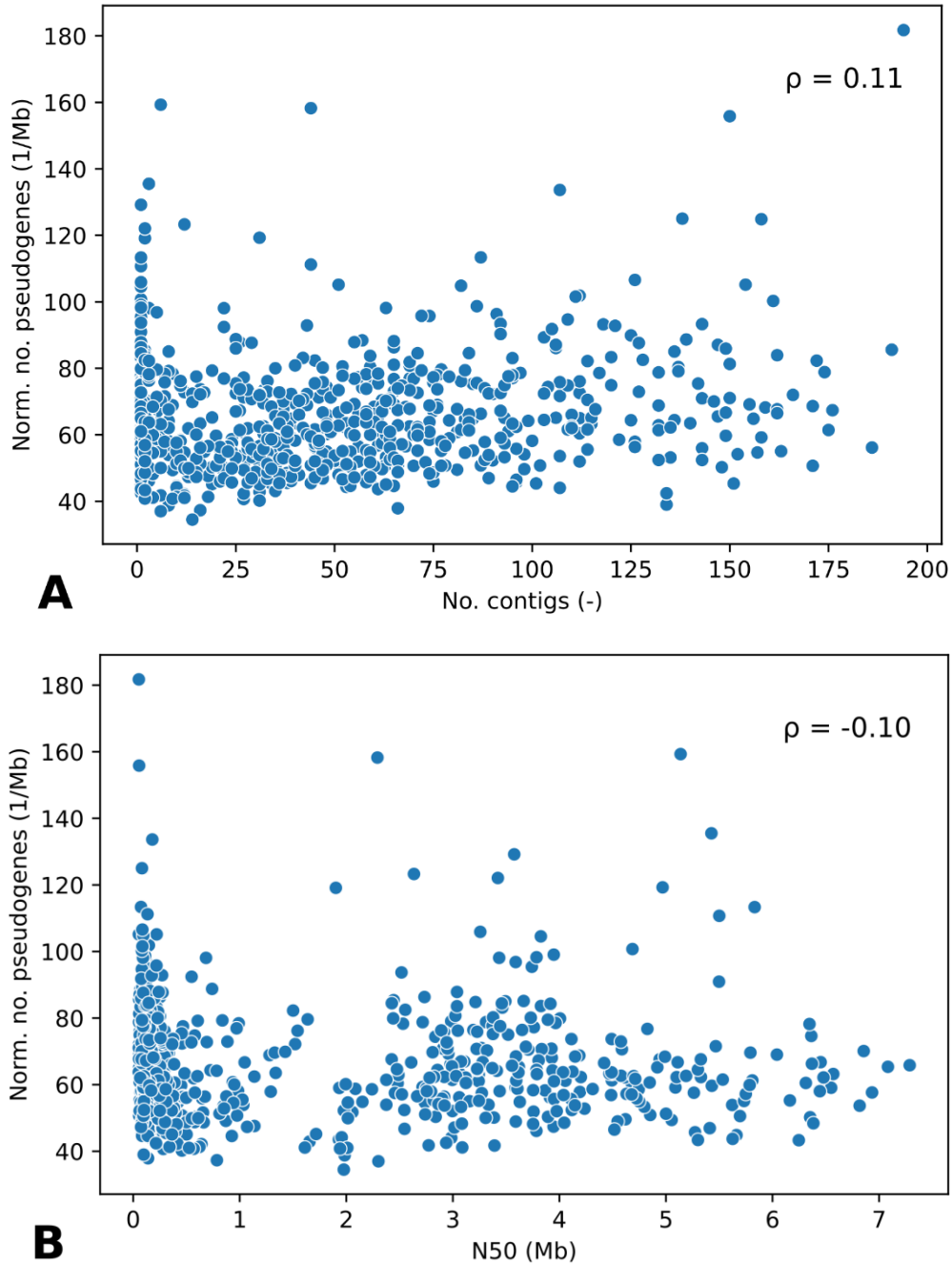


Figure S10. Scatterplots of assembly fragmentation parameters versus pseudogene abundance. (A) Number of contigs. (B) N50. Pseudogene counts were normalised by dividing by the genome length in Mb. Assembly fragmentation likely has no impact on the number of detected pseudogenes. The Spearman correlation coefficient ρ between assembly fragmentation parameters and the detected pseudogene abundance is very low.

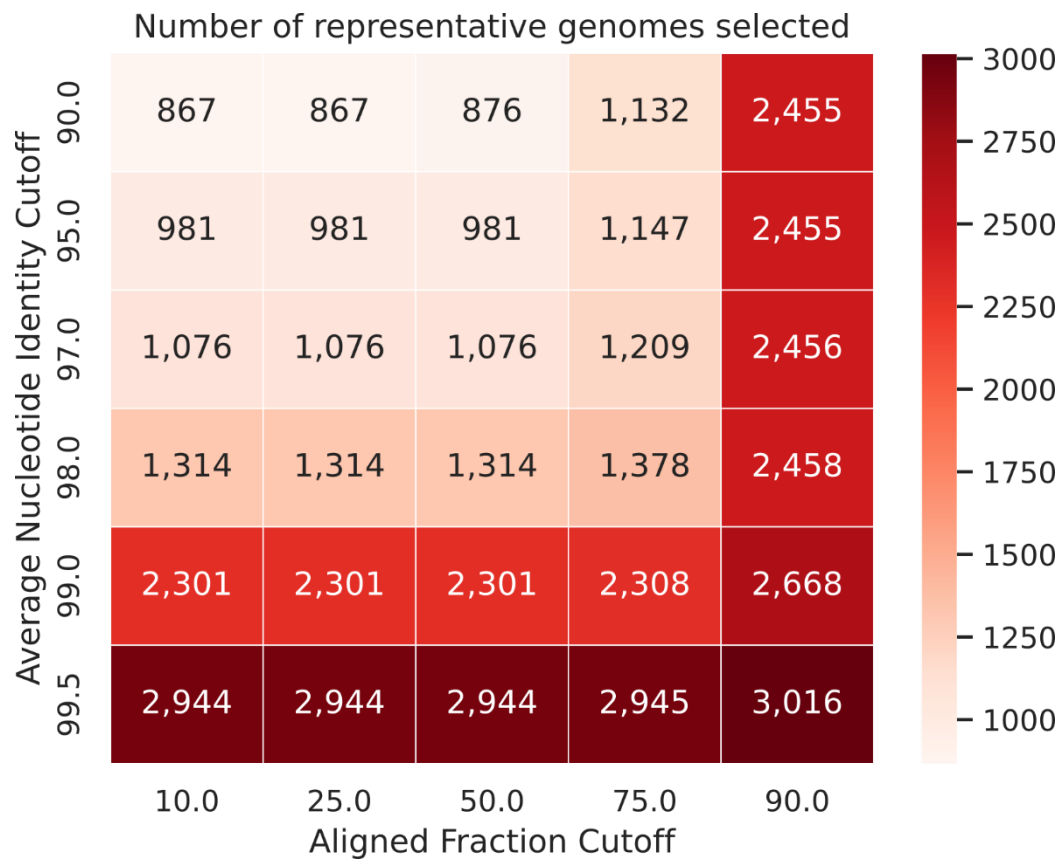


Figure S11. Parameter sensitivity analysis for the genome dereplication using skDER. The sharp increases in representative genomes suggest selecting an ANI cutoff around 97%, and an AF cutoff of 50%. Eventually, we selected an AF cutoff of 50%, and an ANI cutoff of 96%, consistent with the ANI threshold commonly used for species delineation.